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Handbook on Philately

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Handbook on Philately

Chapter I: Definitions of Philatelic Terms

1. Postage Stamp

A postage stamp is a receipt with a specific value to prepay postage. A symbol of a nation's sovereignty, it is also a tool to celebrate and promote a nation's heritage. Its value as a collectible item often exceeds its actual postal value.

2. Types of Postage Stamps

(a) Definitive Stamps

These are stamps specifically issued for day to day postal needs and placed on sale for an unlimited period. They are distinct from commemorative issues and are available in several denominations. The definitives are printed in huge numbers. By and large it can be said that the definitives are normally so designed as to cause the minimum expenditure in their manufacture, storage and sale. A number of definitive series on themes relevant to the country's heritage and progress in various fields have been brought out. Generally the definitive series are changed after **5 years**.

(b) Commemorative Stamps

Stamps, covers or postal stationery issued to commemorate an event, an institution, a theme, flora or fauna and personages, are called commemorative stamps. These are usually printed in limited numbers and are sold for a limited period from philatelic bureaux/counters/authorized offices. These are printed only once, unlike definitive postage stamps, so as to ensure their value as collectibles in accordance with universal practice. They are, however, not intended to supersede the current definitive stamps, and are generally purchased by the philatelists for their collections. These can be used for payment of postage also apart from being collectible items.

(c) Special Stamps

These are thematic like flora, fauna, architecture, art, etc. which are issued without commemorating any specific event.

(d) Joint Issue of Stamps

- (i) This is the simultaneous or agreed issue of stamps (two or more) by India and any other country in consultation with each other.
- (ii) The proposal is taken up by the concerned country directly with India Post or through the Ministry of External Affairs or through its Embassy/High Commission in India. India Post can similarly take up a proposal with any other country.
- (iii) The proposal is forwarded to the International Relation (IR) Division of the Department of Posts for consultation with MEA in order to ascertain its clearance and viability.
- (iv) A draft Joint agreement is drawn up with terms and conditions agreeable to both countries and their respective Postal Organisations. Once the Joint agreement is agreed upon, it is signed by the respective heads of the Philately Division and finalized.
- (v) The concepts for the designs are agreed upon. For example the concept may be 'Endangered Marine Species' (Indo-Philippines 2009) but the species depicted in the design will be different for the two countries. The design itself will vary.
- (vi) The printing of the stamps and ancillary products (such as Miniature Sheets, First Day Covers, Brochures etc.) will be by respective countries with their own denomination and inscription protocol on the layout.
- (vii) Exchange of philatelic material, if any, will be as per the Joint Agreement.
- (viii) The release function protocol in India, if any function is held, will be as usual, but in consultation with the MEA/the Embassy/High Commission etc. IR Division will be kept informed.
- (ix) If an Indian delegation is invited to the country concerned, the case will be processed on merits in accordance with extant rules at the time in consultation with the concerned Divisions/Departments/Ministries.

3. Issue, Release & Presentation

(a) Issues

A stamp issue can consist of a single stamp, a set of 2 or more stamps.

(b) Issue Date

This is the date on which a stamp begins to be sold across the counter in a Post Office/Philatelic Bureau/Counter.

(c) Release

This signifies the process of releasing a stamp by a dignitary during a formal function organized by proponent(s). There can be only one release function, not multiple functions.

(d) Presentation

This can be one or more at different locations on any date on or after the date of release of a stamp.

4. First Day Cover (FDC)

A cover with the stamp franked with special cancellation of the day of issue is brought out along with a commemorative/special postage stamp. This is put on sale on the day of release of the stamp. It can either be sent through post on the first day of its release or can be retained for philatelic collection. First Day covers can also be brought out on the issue or release of definitive stamps.

5. Brochure

Whenever any commemorative/special stamp is issued, a publicity brochure is also brought out. It contains a brief write-up on the subject, designs and also the technical data of the stamp. In addition, the names of the designers of the stamp, first day cover and cancellation are also indicated therein.

6. Cancellation Cachet

It is a cancellation device which is usually impressed with a hand stamp canceller on a cover to denote the date of the special event on which it was provided e.g. important occasions, personages, inaugural flights or expeditions etc. It can also be impressed with the help of a mechanical device for neat cancellation. The cachets are withdrawn from the philatelic bureau immediately **four weeks** after the occasion is over.

The Cancellation cachets are procured by the Heads of the Circles and supplied to all the bureaux under their jurisdiction before the date of release. The manufacturing specifications are as under:

1. Metal to be used: Aluminium
2. Process of preparation of blocks: Photo chemical
3. Aluminium block to be fitted with wooden board
4. Size of the handle: length **11 cms**, excluding the portion to be put into the slot.
Diameter — **1 inch**
5. Wood to be used for handle: Shisham
6. Handle should be fitted to the block with nails or glue in a strong manner so as not to come out while handling.

Note: Changes in the cancellation, if any, will be notified.

7. Mint Sheet

It is a full sheet of unused stamps without any post mark.

8. Issue Sheets

Stamps come in Issue Sheets comprising, generally, **20 to 50** stamps, depending upon the size of the stamp. Anything below that number is a sheetlet in the strictest sense of the term. However, for the sake of specification, various names like Miniature Sheet, Souvenir Sheet, Stamp Sheetlet and Stamp Booklet are attached to the products.

(i) Miniature Sheet

A Miniature Sheet is a sheetlet comprising of one or more postally valid stamps with which the issue concerns. Its size normally varies depending upon the subject illustration, size of the stamp and number of stamps. The outer area of the miniature sheet beyond perforations of the stamp depicts an extension of the theme of the stamp or an elaboration of the same and is of complementary nature. The price of the Miniature sheet may be equal to the face value of the stamp(s) it comprises of, or more, as decided by the Department considering the merit of every case and in that case, the denomination is reflected in the Miniature Sheet. A special feature of a miniature sheet is the zigzag perforation where the sheet is comprised of two or more stamps. However, this feature may not be available in every case. The date of release may be the same as that of the stamp(s) or a specially appointed one.

(ii) Souvenir Sheet

It is also a sheetlet like the miniature sheet, with the exception that it is the issue itself, i.e. while a miniature sheet is issued on stamps and is separately produced and sold, the Souvenir Sheet is the product itself and no separate stamp is sold; therefore, the number of stamps equals the print quantity of the Souvenir Sheet e.g. Mother Teresa.

(iii) Stamp Sheetlet

A sheetlet of stamps is a smaller version of a full issue sheet of stamps. It generally contains **16 to 20** stamps. It also has, like the Miniature Sheet, complementary illustrations/elaborations and inscriptions. The primary aim of producing a sheetlet is to meet the demand of the philatelist/collectors for a sheet of stamps of manageable size. However, it is not necessary to bring out sheetlets on every occasion of issues. The price of a sheetlet is invariably the sum of the face value of the stamps it is comprised of.

(iv) Stamp Booklet

It is intended to be made of suitable size to facilitate a customer who needs to go to post offices off and on to purchase stamps for postage. It, therefore, is necessarily related to definitive stamps. A booklet may contain a strip of, say, **20 stamps** or less tucked inside the booklet's inner fold by gumming the selvedge of the specially produced strip. The

outer cover may have illustrations and detailed inscriptions. It may be priced at the face value of the stamps it contains.

9. Special Cover

An event which is not nationally important enough to be commemorated by issue of commemorative/special stamp or for which a stamp cannot be accommodated in the annual issue programme may be commemorated by the Department by issue of Special Covers which can be cancelled with a special cancellation at the post office selected for the purpose. Such covers can also be issued at the instance of private parties on payment of requisite charges. These covers should bear minimum postage stamps of any kind equivalent to the minimum inland letter mail rate. Heads of the Circles are the competent authority to sanction Special Covers commemorating any event/institution/inaugural flight under their jurisdiction.

10. First Flight Cover

The cover which is carried on the inaugural mail flight between two points by an airline and which bears the marks of the two places is called First Flight Cover.

11. Pictorial Cancellation

These are permanent, regular date cancellations provided at any post office located at a place of tourist attraction. It normally features the major tourist attraction of the place. The Head of Circle is empowered to approve this cancellation. It is advisable to have a pictorial cancellation in places of special interest.

12. Perforation

A series of holes are punched along the boundaries of the stamps in the sheet to facilitate separation of the stamps from each other.

13. Albums

From time to time, albums are prepared by the Philately Division of the Directorate and the philatelic bureaux for presentation purposes and stamp release functions. There are

different types of albums, one of which is prepared at the time of release of a new special/commemorative stamp/special cover.

14. Blow Up

This is a hand painted or digital enlargement of a postage stamp, generally used at a release function where it is unveiled as a token of release. It is also available for purchase in limited quantities as it is made only on demand.

15. Collector's Packs

Collector's packs contain a set of all the commemorative/special postage stamps issued by the Department during the year. These are put on sale at Philatelic Bureaux and can be made available at philatelic counters and authorized offices on request. These are made in a limited quantity.

16. Thematic Packs

The Department issues from time to time a set of two or more stamps on particular themes. Small packs are prepared containing these stamps and are placed on sale at Philatelic Bureaux so that all the stamps issued on a theme are available in one pack. These can be supplied through philatelic counters/authorized offices if requested for.

17. List/Catalogue of India Postage Stamps

The list contains information on definitive as well as special/commemorative stamps including service stamps. A List/Catalogue of India postage stamps issued since **1947** is put on sale at Philatelic Bureaux at the price fixed by the Department.

18. Posters/Fliers

The Department periodically issues publicity leaflets which are known as fliers, for free distribution to the philatelists/collectors in order to give advance publicity to the proposed stamps to be issued. Sometimes various posters are issued by the Department to give publicity to the forthcoming stamps as well as to popularize the hobby of stamp collection amongst the people. These are to be displayed prominently in Philatelic Bureaux/Counters and other important Post Offices as soon as they are received.

19. Newsletter

A newsletter is published by the Postal Department periodically. These newsletters contain information about the stamp as well as future issues of commemorative/special stamps, special covers, cancellations as also the holding of exhibitions. This is supplied on request to individuals, philatelic clubs/societies, philatelic stamp dealers, stamp collectors etc. of the country and abroad free of charge.

20. Exhibits

It is an album sheet of standard size **23 x 29 cm** in white or off-white colour without any margin. All exhibits must be mounted on standard loose-leaf quadrille album pages, and enclosed in transparent protective covers of sufficient firmness. Exhibits mounted on other than specified pages, do not meet the requirements of model regulations for state/circle level philatelic exhibitions, and will not be displayed in such exhibitions.

21. Meghdoot Postcard

The Meghdoot Post Card is a variant of normal post cards and was introduced by the Business Development Directorate of the Department as a premium product w.e.f. **1st September 2002**. The space for writing on the address side is utilized for multi-colour advertisements of different products and services by the clients at a fixed rate determined from time to time. The client also indicates the territory of release or circulation of the Meghdoot Post Cards. In addition to territories designated by the client, limited numbers of Meghdoot Post Cards are available for sale from **seven** selected Philatelic Bureaux authorized for sale of new postal stationery.

22. Philatelic Bureau

A Philatelic Bureau is a branch of a Head or Sub Post Office specifically set up by the Department to deal with the receipt and sale of all philatelic items, like special/commemorative stamps, first day covers, special covers, new issue on definitive stamps and new stationery etc. It also provides special cancellations on F.D.Cs and special covers, or on covers presented to the bureau for the purpose of special cancellations. It maintains up-to-date record and relevant information of all the issues for supply to the

stamp collectors and intending purchasers. It maintains Philatelic Deposit Accounts and also deals with mail orders.

23. Philatelic Counter

The Philatelic Counter is a counter for sale of philatelic items and is a part of the post office specially selected for the purpose. A Philatelic counter is functioning in each Head Post Office. These counters, however, do not provide special cancellation on F.D.Cs or special covers, but a standard cancellation of "First Day of Issue" only, which is the same for all the philatelic issues. These counters offer registration facility for opening of Philatelic Deposit Account with supply of material by the parent bureau.

24. Authorized Office

The authorized office is a post office, which sells philatelic items but does not provide any special cancellation. These offices in addition to philatelic bureau and philatelic counters are specially authorized by the Head of Circles to sell philatelic items.

25. National Philatelic Museum

Each postage stamp is a carefully designed piece of miniature art which speaks evocatively about the subject depicted on it. India has brought out beautiful stamps covering different facets of this great country. The National Philatelic Museum, New Delhi, attempts to showcase the great Indian panorama as presented through its postage stamps. Located in Dak Bhavan, Sansad Marg, New Delhi, the Museum houses all Indian stamps issued since Independence. The main display is the chronological series in which all the commemorative and special stamps issued by the Department of Posts have been presented. Blow-ups of stamps as well as stamp-designs painted by children add colour to the Museum. Exhibits prepared by accomplished philatelists are kept on display from time to time, exposing the visitor to some of the treasures of philately in the country. The process of designing and printing of postage stamps have also been displayed in serialized exhibits. In addition, the Museum provides information with regard to the Postal History of India as well as India's Philatelic Heritage. A unique wealth of items is thus available for view in the Museum. The sale counter at the Museum offers the latest postage stamps, First Day Covers and other philatelic material.

Chapter II: Philatelic Bureaux and Counters

26. Philatelic Bureaux are established by the Heads of Circles on orders issued by the Directorate. The pre-requisites for the establishment of a Philatelic Bureau are the expected sale of philatelic items, namely, commemorative/special postage stamps, first day covers, information sheets, collector packs, special philatelic packs, philatelic publications and covers etc. Besides the demand for philatelic issues and items, existence of philatelic societies and clubs in a particular place are also considered before opening of a Philatelic Bureau. Heads of the Circles, before sending a proposal for opening a bureau are, therefore, required to give the sale figures of philatelic items for the preceding **six months**, and the number of clubs/societies working at the stations. Normally a new philatelic bureau is not opened unless a philatelic counter has been working satisfactorily in a particular station.

27. Philatelic counters are functioning at all the Head Post Offices. The Head of the Circle is competent to open a philatelic counter at any Sub Post Office in his jurisdiction after he is personally satisfied with the necessity of opening such a counter. The following guidelines may be kept in view while examining proposals for opening of philatelic counters:

- (i) The place should be a very important tourist centre;
- (ii) There should be a popular demand from the public/philatelists;
- (iii) There should be a considerable number of philatelic clubs/societies;
- (iv) The proposed office should have accessibility by Air/Train etc;
- (v) The office should be an important sub post office;
- (vi) The average monthly sale from the authorized office which is proposed to be converted into a philatelic counter may not be less than **Rs. 10,000/-**.

28. Distinction between a Philatelic Bureau and a Philatelic Counter

Philatelic Bureaux and counters are not independent offices but are a part and parcel of the Post office. Philatelic Bureaux are preferably established in Head Post Offices located

at Circle headquarters, district towns and Sub Post Offices where considered necessary. Where the opening of a bureau is not found justified, a philatelic counter may be opened in a departmental sub-post office. While bureaux carry out all philatelic functions and supply philatelic items to dependent counters and to post offices specially authorized by the Heads of the Circles, the philatelic counters do philatelic work in a restricted way. They are not authorized to issue special cancellations. The philatelic counters offer the facility of registration of Philatelic Deposit Account with material to be supplied by the parent bureau. It is also not authorized to accept mail orders. It is, however, allowed to provide "first day of issue" cancellation on first day covers. For this purpose it is provided with permanent cancellation stamp with changeable dates. Authorized offices only sell commemorative/special stamps, blank first day covers and information sheets.

29. Functions of Philatelic Bureaux

Philatelic Bureaux are under the technical and administrative control of the Postmaster. In the case of philatelic counters, they are under the administrative control of the respective postmasters whereas for technical purposes they are under the control of the bureau on which they are dependent for the supplies of philatelic articles viz. stamps, first day cover, information sheets etc.

29.1 The major functions of Philatelic Bureaux are to receive and sell:

- Commemorative and special postage stamps and philatelic ancillaries.
- Definitive postage stamps on their first day of issue.
- First day covers and special covers.
- Information sheets.
- New postal stationery with advertisement.

(Stationery with advertisement will be sold only through the Philatelic Bureaux at Bangalore, Chennai, Hyderabad, Kolkata, Lucknow, Mumbai and Sansad Marg, New Delhi, for a period of **one month** from the date of release or till the stock lasts, whichever is earlier).

- Other items like mini/souvenir sheets, collector's packs etc.
- Philatelic products such as books, gifts & other merchandise.

29.2 In addition, the bureau also:

- (i) Provides special cancellations on the first day of issue.
- (ii) Supplies philatelic stamps and its ancillaries to all the philatelic counters in its technical jurisdiction (as mentioned in above para) before the day of release.
- (iii) Supplies material to PDA holders registered at philatelic counters.
- (iv) Operates an imprest sanctioned by the Head of the Circle for getting supply of stamps from the treasury for sale at the counter.
- (v) Maintains Philatelic Deposit Accounts.
- (vi) Executes mail orders of philatelic stamps, FDCs and brochures etc.
- (vii) Complies with bulk sale of mint stamps.
- (viii) Assists philatelists, stamp dealers, collectors and members of the public for supply of information about the latest issues and their connected information.
- (ix) Maintains a philatelic library.
- (x) Opens extension counters at stamp release functions especially organized by the Heads of the Circles and others.
- (xi) Assists the Heads of the Circles, Regional Directors and Superintendents of Post Offices concerned in organizing philatelic exhibitions, seminars, workshops etc.
- (xii) Adopts measures for sale of philatelic materials under the instructions of the Heads of the Circles.

(xiii) Submits periodical statement showing the sale of commemorative/special postage stamps and other philatelic materials and numbers of P.D. Accounts. Any other item of philatelic work entrusted by the Head of the Circle.

(xiv) Maintains a register showing the names and address of philatelic clubs and societies and also reputed philatelists of the town.

(xv) Keeps the catalogue of stamps updated by making entry of each stamp (commemorative/definitive) as and when issued.

(xvi) All Bureaux/HO treasuries are progressively being networked to utilize the Software for Philatelic Inventory Management. Connectivity is also provided with CSDs/Circle offices/Philately Division of the Directorate for MIS on a need to know basis. This software intends to update, expedite and monitor indents, invoice forecasts, stocks in hand, sales and revenue.

30. Display of Stamps in the Philatelic Bureau

It is essential that the stamps and first day covers issued by the Department are chronologically arranged and kept in an album as reference materials for the benefit of customers and philatelists.

Chapter III: Stamps

31. The issue of a stamp is notified by means of a circular issued by the Directorate well in advance of the date of release to all the Heads of the Circles/Regional Postmasters General and the philatelic bureaux. The circular contains full information about stamps including their technical data. Photo prints of stamp(s) as and when available are also sent along with the circular for the purpose of advance publicity. The Head of the Circle will ensure that all the bureaux, counters as well as authorized offices are informed of the date of issue, subject and denomination of the commemorative stamp(s) indicated in the circular. On receipt of the circular it will be the responsibility of the Postmaster to give as much publicity as possible and display the copy of the circular on the notice board at a prominent place in the bureau. A press note is sent to the DPIO for giving publicity through the media.

32. It is very important to ensure that the stamp is not sold under any circumstances before the date of issue as notified in the circular. In case the date fixed for issue of stamp happens to be Sunday/postal holiday, the Philatelic Bureaux in New Delhi and the place of issue of the stamp will open for sale of stamps, first day covers, etc. while the sale of these items at the other bureaux/counters will be effected and the cancellation of the actual date of release provided on the next working day. If for some unavoidable technical/administrative reasons, the issue of the stamp is postponed/advanced, Directorate will inform all the Heads of the Circles about the postponement/advancement and the latter will intimate all the bureaux/counters in the Circle. On receipt of the information that the issue of the stamp has been advanced or postponed, it will be the personal responsibility of the Postmaster to ensure that the information is promptly conveyed to all concerned and stamp is not issued on the previously notified date of issue.

33. The commemorative/special postage stamps are sent in secured packets bearing in advance the date of issue from the authorized stamp depot, to all philatelic bureaux and selected philatelic counters. The number of stamps which will be received by a bureau or a counter is fixed by the Directorate. Depending on the total number of stamps printed for each issue, a quota is fixed for the bureaux and counters (Annex I). On receipt of the stamp packets, the Postmaster shall verify if the authorized quota of stamps has been received. Each stamp packet will have a printed label "Not to be sold before date" pasted on it. The Postmaster, therefore, shall have the packet opened in his presence and have the number of sheets counted in each packet to see if there is any discrepancy. He will immediately ensure the safe custody of the stamp packets. Such of the new stamps as are required to be supplied to other attached philatelic counters and authorized offices shall be dispatched well in advance of the date of release of the stamp as per the quota fixed by the Head of the Circle. While dispatching the stamps to other offices, warning should also be given to them that these will not be sold in any circumstances before the date of the issue.

34. Register of Commemorative Stamps Balances

The treasurer of the Head Post Office or the Sub Post Office, which sells commemorative postal stamps shall maintain the register in the prescribed proforma as used for postal stamps and stationery, separately indicating name of the stamps vertically and balance as on date against each, casting the total at the foot of the vertical column. Immediately on receipt of the stamps they will be entered in the register chronologically and the amount noted as per face value. The value of the stamps received would form part of cash balance of the post office and will be treated like other stamps and stationery. Whenever stamps are dispatched to other dependent counters or authorized offices either under Remittance Advice or S.O. slips, entries will be made in this register by the treasurer.

The treasurer will maintain this register in addition to the stamp register maintained for definitive and other non-postage stamps. Like stamp register, daily totals of this register will be transferred to the H.O. Summary. As and when supply of stamps is made to the attached philatelic bureau or the counter functioning in the office for sale, recoupment of cash will be made by the treasurer against the stamp imprest given to the incharge of the philatelic bureau/counter. The purpose of the register is to maintain correct accounting and to ascertain on any date the stock position of commemorative/special postage stamps. A register of commemorative/special stamps released as per format in Annex II will be maintained in the philatelic bureau. It will be the personal responsibility of incharge of the philatelic bureau to keep the register updated.

A Software for Philatelic Inventory Management of all philatelic items (definitives, postal stationery and commemorative/special stamps) is being introduced across the Department in a phased way and all concerned should adopt it. This is mandatory. It is intended to update stock and sales position, indicate revenue, and facilitate forecasting and indenting.

35. Sale of Commemorative/Special Stamps

Commemorative/special stamps should not be given for sale through stamp vendors and licensed agents, but should be sold only through philatelic bureaux/counters and authorized offices. The incharge of philatelic bureau must obtain the supply of the stamps

from the authorized stamp depot, for sale of stamps at the philatelic bureau or the counter. Before the stamps are put on sale on the day of release, adequate stock of stamps for meeting the requirement of PD Account holders may be retained. On the date of release, the existing staff working in the philatelic counters may not be adequate in the big offices to cope with the sale on the existing counters. The Postmaster will have to make arrangement for additional counters and draw officials from other branches. At the close of each day, the incharge of the bureau/counter will transfer the sale proceeds to the treasurer as per existing post office procedure. Under no circumstances the philatelic bureau will hold cash or stamps or both in excess of the imprest allowed to it. The philatelic bureau/counter will sell commemorative/special stamps of each issue for a period of **6 months** from the month of issue or till the supply lasts, whichever is earlier. At the end of **6 months**, stamps on personalities, events and institutions should be transferred to the Philatelic Bureau of the GPO/HO at the Circle HQ of the Circle to which the stamp relates. For instance, if a stamp relates to a personality from Tamil Nadu, all remaining stamps at other bureaux and counters may be sent under an advice of transfer to Anna Road HO at Chennai. A list of the identified POs to which the stamps may be transferred is at Annex III (list of HOs/POs for transfer after **6 months**).

35.1 To provide greater visibility and availability, the commemorative stamps remaining unsold after **6 months** will be released for sale along with definitive stamps at the stamp vending counter of the parent office and also be remitted to all other Post Offices who do not sell philatelic stamps, under the usual remittance procedure. The multicoloured stamps of higher denominations after remaining on sale for **6 months** at the bureau should be issued for sale at Speed Post/Parcel/Registration counters.

35.2 Sometimes before the issue of the stamp the proponent/interested parties desire to purchase the stamp and its ancillaries. The Head of the Circles/Regional PMsG may ascertain the actual requirement of the products and inform the Directorate at least **one month** in advance, if the demand cannot be met from the quota fixed for the philatelic bureau in the Circle. The payment for the additional requirement should be obtained in advance and credited under head Unclassified Receipts and intimation given to Philately branch of Directorate for arranging the supply.

In case of additional requirement of stamps after its issue, the philatelic bureau would inform the Head of the Circle/Regional PMG who will explore the possibility of meeting

the requirement by taking it up at inter circle level directly. The Central Base Post Offices shall take up the matter through APS with Chief Postmaster General, New Delhi/Kolkata as the case may be.

35.3 Before stamps are put on sale at the counter or any diversion of stamps is effected, retention of adequate stock of stamp(s) for meeting the requirement of PD Accounts must be ensured.

Chapter IV: First Day Covers & Information Sheets

36. With the issue of a new commemorative/special stamp, a First Day Cover (FDC) is also issued. FDCs are printed and supplied by the Postal Directorate, through Philatelic Bureau, Sansad Marg HPO, New Delhi to all the Bureaux. These covers are of two sizes i.e. **13 × 20 cms** and **11 × 20 cms**. The quota of FDCs for each Bureau is fixed by the Postal Directorate which is subject to review from time to time depending on the sales. FDCs are not, however, normally supplied to authorized offices as they are not authorized to provide First Day of Issue cancellation. These are supplied in advance of the date of issue of the stamp. Philatelic Bureaux, however, may indent additional quantities, if such additional demand is anticipated, due to any issue. This demand should, however, reach the Directorate at least **one month** in advance of the date of the release so that the Directorate can arrange to make the supply.

On receipt of the First Day Covers in the Bureau, the incharge should count them to see that they have been received correctly as per invoice received and then enter the quantity received in the stock register specially maintained for this purpose. He should supply the FDCs to all the philatelic counters in advance of the date of release as per quota prescribed by the Head of the Circle.

37. Sale of First Day Covers

First Day Covers, blank or stamped, cannot be sold before the date of issue of the stamp. FDCs having the newly issued stamp(s) affixed on them and duly cancelled with the special cancellation of the first day of the issue can be sold on the date of release of the stamp. The 'First Day Issue Cancellation' on the first day covers having the concerned

commemorative postage stamp(s) affixed on them, will continue to be provided for a period of **four weeks** from the actual date of issue of the concerned commemorative stamp(s). Since FDCs are philatelic items, a purchaser often collects them without any intention of posting.

Sometimes, philatelists and collectors post the covers to their friends and it is necessary that this should be posted for transmission as an article of mail with the date of issue cancellation on the first day of issue by presenting it at the philatelic counter. First Day Covers should not be posted in letter boxes as in that event there is a chance of their being cancelled with the date stamp of the collecting post office which will devalue their philatelic importance. Blank First Day Covers can, however, be used as envelopes without the 'First Day Issue Cancellation' and can be posted in the letterboxes.

Before the first day covers are put on sale at the counter on the day of issue, and also prior to making supply to other post offices, the incharge should keep aside the numbers of FDCs sufficient to meet the requirement of the PD Account holders.

The amount realized through sale of FDCs should be credited to account under unclassified receipt. The incharge of the philatelic bureau is responsible to carry out the check and to tally the account with the stock register on a periodical basis.

38. Disposal of First Day Covers

The blank first day covers remaining unsold after **six months** from the month of issue of the respective commemorative/special postage stamps will be obliterated on the motif if printed on such covers with a thick cross "X" and superscribed with the word "On Postal Service". This may be done by means of a rubber stamp by the Philatelic Bureau. They may be utilized purely for inter departmental use and under no circumstances such covers be sent to members of the public. However, FDCs (after **6 months**) relating to personalities should be transferred to the CPO/HO of the headquarters of the Circle to which the personality relates.

39. Information Sheets

Information sheets or brochures are printed and supplied by the Postal Directorate to all philatelic bureaux through Philatelic Bureau, Sansad Marg HO, New Delhi as per the

quota fixed for each issue much in advance of the date of issue of the stamps to which they pertain. On receipt, they should be checked and entered in the stock register like FDCs. These cannot be sold before the issue of the stamp. It should be ensured that Philatelic Bureaux indent for these items in a realistic manner to ensure that unsold quantities are kept to the minimum.

Sometimes philatelists and collectors request that special cancellation should be provided on the information sheets which they keep as a collectible item. This should be provided on request.

40. Disposal of Unsold Information Sheet

Information sheets remaining unsold after **6 months** from the date of issue of the concerned commemorative or special postage stamp may be disposed of in a manner so as to give a fillip to philately and philatelic sales and to inculcate the hobby of stamp collection among the younger generation e.g. free distribution amongst students in educational institutions or during philatelic exhibitions, or given to philatelic clubs and societies. These may be written off from the stock register at the end of **six months**, except those on personalities which should be transferred to the GPO/HO of the headquarters of the Circle to which the personality relates.

Incharge of the philatelic bureau will ensure periodically that the sale proceeds of brochures are duly credited to the post office account. He will check the unsold brochures in stock with the stock register and initial the entries in token of having done so.

A copy of the brochure should be displayed on the notice board of the Head Post Office for information of the public.

Chapter V: Procedure for Supply to Philatelists and Collectors

41. A philatelic bureau deals with the supply of only the current India special postage stamps, as and when they are newly issued. This also includes F.D.Cs and special covers issued on any event or occasion, as per notifications issued previously by the Department. Orders for supply of such stamps should be accompanied by remittances, either by a money order or postal order and should contain the full address to which the stamps are to be sent. The remittances should include an extra amount to cover postage and insurance fee, if so desired.

Every attempt should be made to execute such orders according to instructions contained in the application as long as the stamps are available. Sometimes whenever a new or revised item of postal stationery such as postcards, inland letter cards, aerogrammes, embossed envelopes, registration envelopes are released for sale from specified date, the philatelists and collectors often desire to have them cancelled with the date stamp impression of the philatelic bureau so as to indicate that the articles in question were actually procured by them on the date of issue. If so desired by the philatelists and collectors, the new or revised items of postal stationery may be cancelled with the date stamp impression of the philatelic bureau on the date of their issue only, even if they are not addressed, and handed over to the purchasers. However, it may be made clear to the parties that such cancelled items of postal stationery will not be accepted for transmission if posted in any letter box or at any office other than the philatelic bureau concerned or on any other date. Sometimes advance orders for supply of such cancelled items of stationery are also received. Such orders should be booked by the philatelic bureau under the same terms and conditions as those for new stamps and first day covers.

42. Supplies should be made in sheets, in blocks and also in loose labels as the dealers or the collectors may desire. While selecting the mint sheets of stamps, it should be ensured that they do not bear any pencil writings on their back. The sheets should not be creased or folded in places. The stamps in the sheets should have well centred perforations. While breaking up the sheet for executing small orders, the sheet should be first folded to the breaking line so that the perforations do not get damaged or torn. The stamps with gum stains or marks of any kind are of no use to the stamp collectors, and, therefore, should not be sent.

43. Packing

While packing stamps, they must not be kept in a manner so that two gummed sides touch each other as in that case stamps may get stuck and become useless. To avoid this, a full sheet may be folded in half, the printed side facing each other. A blank transparent sheet of paper cut to convenient size, must be kept between each sheet before dispatch. All stamps must be sent duly protected between two cardboards. Small orders may be dispatched in cloth-bound covers. Small orders may also be sent in transparent polythene envelopes enclosed in outer paper cover. Large size parcels, besides being protected by cardboards, must be first wrapped in a packing paper to avoid cardboard edges coming out of the wrappers and damaging the stamps.

44. Mail Orders

Sometimes whenever a series of stamps are issued mail order forms are got printed by the Department and distributed free to the philatelists and collectors in order to facilitate their booking of advance orders for the commemorative/special stamps.

44.1 The following procedure will be followed in respect of the receipt and adjustment of cash payments received in advance for supply of F.D.Cs, and new stamps from time to time by the philatelic bureau.

44.2 All the cash received by a philatelic bureau for supply of F.D.Cs, brochures and new stamps will be taken as payment by the postmaster who will grant a receipt in form ACG-67 and account for the amount under "Unclassified Receipts" and maintain the following particulars in respect of each transaction in a separate register, opened for the purpose.

1. Date of receipt.
2. Name and address of the philatelist.
3. Details of FDCs, brochures and stamps etc. ordered.
4. Value of the FDCs, brochures and stamps etc. plus the postage for dispatch.
5. Total amount received.
6. No. of receipt in form ACG-67.

7. Initials of the Treasurer for the receipt of the amount as entered in column 5.
8. Date of final adjustment and manner of adjustment (in case the stamps are sent by post, the number and date of the registered letter or in case these are delivered at counter, dated signature of the recipient to be indicated/taken there).

44.3 The officer-in-charge of the philatelic bureau will enter the details in columns 1 to 6. On the day on which the stamps are to be issued in respect of which advance remittances have been received, the Postmaster will charge it under "Unclassified Payments". The charge under UCP should be supported by covering sanction (accompanied by an extract of the register) issued by the Divisional Superintendent/Postmaster (Group 'B' and above) as the case may be.

45. In respect of those orders which are to be delivered over the counter, the officer-in-charge of the philatelic bureau will prepare separate covers for each philatelist and deliver them over the counter after obtaining their dated initials in the register in column 8, a remark to the effect that the supplies have been made over in person being recorded on the back of the original receipt in form ACG-67. In respect of the orders which are to be sent by post, the officer-in-charge of philatelic bureau will take necessary action to arrange dispatch of stamps and stationery by registered post, prepared with postage and paste the receipt against the order in the register. If any order is not taken delivery of across the counter, these packets will be kept separate by the officer-in-charge/supervisor of the philatelic bureau for delivery at a subsequent date.

46. Any account left over after meeting the cost of the order, will be returned in the form of current postage stamps and in case the remittance falls short of the required amount, reduction of the corresponding value will be made in the order.

47. It is emphasized that while dispatching the philatelic items, against the orders, the material should be properly packed with cellophane envelopes and cardboards to give proper protection to the philatelic items so that the envelopes may not give way during transit. Bubble packing may be used where deemed fit.

48. It is likely that opening and operating of Philatelic Deposit Accounts online will be enabled through the e-post office. In that case, the operational instructions for that will be suitably notified.

Chapter VI: Cancellation

49. Cancellation

Cancellation provided by philatelic bureaux can be of the following types:

- (i) Special First Day Cancellation
- (ii) Special Place Cancellation
- (iii) Philatelic Exhibition Cancellation
- (iv) Pictorial Cancellation
- (v) Special cancellation provided to commemorate any event, institutions and inaugural flights.

50. Special First Day Cancellation

Special first day cancellations and first day issue cancellation are provided on the first day covers, private covers and album pages having the commemorative stamps affixed thereon at the philatelic bureaux for **six months** from the day of issue of the stamp(s). The philatelic counters do not provide special first day cancellation though they use a standard cancellation with the words "First Day of Issue" along with changeable date stamp of the office of issue on the date on which a commemorative/special postage stamp is issued.

51. The Philatelic Bureaux/Counters are supplied with date stamps with the inscriptions "Philatelic Bureau" or "Philatelic Counter" and a hand stamp with the legend "First Day of Issue". These stamps must be kept in the personal custody of the Postmaster/Asstt. Postmaster/Supervisor/Incharge of the Philatelic Bureau/Counter and he will be held

responsible if the stamp is put to improper use. The types meant for this stamp should not be used for other stamps in the office.

51.1 The ordinary date stamp with the inscriptions "Philatelic Bureau" or "Philatelic Counter" will be used by the Bureau or the Counter to cancel the postal stationery bearing advertisements. The stamp bearing the legend "First Day of Issue" will be used by the Philatelic Bureau and the Counter whenever new stationery with a new design is issued. In case of Philatelic Counters these stamps will be used whenever special commemorative stamps are issued since special cancellations cachets are not supplied to them.

51.2 A common design of the cancellation cachet to be used for the particular special/commemorative stamp(s) is sent to all the Heads of the Circles by Philately Branch of Postal Directorate, well in advance of the actual date of issue. The Head of the Circle will get the cancellation cachet for all philatelic bureaux in his jurisdiction manufactured and supplied so as to reach the bureaux before the date of issue. The cachet should be in consistence with the specification indicated in rule 6 of the Handbook. The special cancellation cachets should on receipt and after checking be kept under the personal custody of the Postmaster. They must be used only on the designated dates. All Heads of Circles are advised to check their e-mail so that cachets are prepared well in time and they are alerted to any change of dates.

51.3 Care must be taken to see that cachets bear correct date, month and year before bringing them into use. This should be checked up by the clerk and supervisor personally and they should place their initials in the Book of Post Marks against the impression taken in token of having carried out the check. The use of ink of any colour other than black is prohibited. The cancellation should be provided using black ink only.

52. Return of Special Cancellation Cachet

The 'First Day Issue Cancellation' on the First Day Covers continues to be provided for a period of **six months** from the actual day of issue of the commemorative stamp. The special covers also remain on sale and special cancellations are provided at the nominated post offices for a period of **six months** from the date of issue. It may sometimes happen that some orders for the first day covers and special covers placed before the date of issue

of stamp(s) and special covers may be received by post at the Bureau even after the date of issue. These orders should be honoured. The philatelic bureau will retain the cachet under the personal custody of the Postmaster after the date of issue of the new stamp or the date of the issue of the special cover for executing the mail orders and for providing the special cancellation on the First Day Covers and special covers. The cancellation cachet should, however, be returned positively to the Supdt. Postal Forms and Seals, Aligarh after **six months** of the release of the stamp or **one month** in case of special cover after executing the mail orders and supply to deposit account holders. Change in orders regarding disposal if any will be notified.

53. Special Place Cancellations

Sometimes special cancellations are provided by the Department at the places other than the philatelic bureau and philatelic counters which have a special significance in relation to the special/commemorative stamp issued by the Department. Information in regard to such cancellations is issued by the Department in the form of circulars to the official agencies and in the form of newsletter/postal notice for the benefit of the philatelists and collectors.

Places having special significance in relation to the commemorative stamp are described in the brochure of the stamp. The collectors may desire to have the special place cancellation on the articles carrying the commemorative or other stamps. The Post Offices at places of special significance should provide their own cancellation on the article on demand. Whenever possible a pictorial cancellation may be provided. It is not necessary to send the articles to the philatelic bureaux/counter unless it is asked for, if a pictorial cancellation is available at the place of posting.

54. Philatelic Exhibition Cancellations

Philatelic Exhibition Cancellations can be approved by the Heads of the Circles on the occasion of the philatelic exhibitions organized properly by the philatelic clubs, societies and organizations. Such cancellations can also be provided on the occasion of philatelic exhibitions held by non-philatelic organizations, such as educational institutions, clubs, and associations like Rotary or Lions International etc. Periodically, philatelic exhibitions are also organized by the Postal Department at the circle level or district level. National

and International Philatelic Exhibitions are organized by the Postal Directorate, New Delhi. Heads of the Circles also have the power to permit to provide cancellations in advance of the philatelic exhibition organized by the Department in order to give advance publicity for the exhibition. Such cancellations are provided at selected post offices in the Circle. The Postmaster General may approve special cancellations for philatelic exhibitions, departmental or non-departmental, in consultation with the Head of the Circle.

55. Pictorial Cancellations

Pictorial Cancellations are provided by the Department in post offices which are located at places of major historical importance or tourist attraction. Such cancellations are introduced on a specific date. Information in this regard, is issued through circulars/notices and newsletter for advance publicity so that the collectors know about the introduction of such cancellations. These cancellations will replace the ordinary round date stamp cancellation of the particular post office and will be in use as a regular measure in the post office until the discontinuance is ordered by the Head of the Circle. The Postmaster General may approve these cancellations in consultation with the Head of the Circle.

56. Special Cancellation

Heads of Circles are the competent authority to sanction special cancellation and covers commemorating any event/institution/inaugural flight under their jurisdiction subject to the following terms and conditions:

A. A special cancellation with or without a special cover may be approved keeping in mind the following points:

- (i) The subject/occasion is of considerable importance/relevance at the State level.
- (ii) It will boost local philatelic interest.
- (iii) The subject/occasion is non-controversial and bears no communal or political overtones.

(iv) The proponents are of repute with established credibility. They should not be indulging in activities which may be a cause of embarrassment to the Government of India.

B. The Proponent will provide the following details/material to the Heads of the Circle for consideration of the proposal.

(i) The proposed date of issue.

(ii) Proposed design for the special cancellation.

(iii) Name(s) of the post office(s) or/and the venue from where such special cancellations are to be provided.

C. The legend in the cancellation design should be bilingual (first in Hindi and then English) indicating the date mentioning only the event/occasion being commemorated. The design should incorporate the name and the PIN of the post office where the special cancellation is to be provided. In case the special cancellation is to be provided at a separate venue, it should be the PIN of the post office in whose delivery jurisdiction the venue is located. The design should be in the form of a line drawing so that the impressions are neat and clean.

D. The design of the cancellation should be of secular nature and should be devoid of any nuances which may cause embarrassment to the Government.

E. The proponent will be required to pay to the Department in advance, the fees prescribed from time to time.

F. The cachet(s) for the special cancellation should be as per the design approved by the Head of the Circle and will be manufactured by the concerned Circle Office.

56.1 The Department reserves the right to reject any application for special cancellation or to disallow or modify any design or inscription in the special cancellation without assigning any reason.

56.2 All cancellations should be neat and clean. Cachets should be properly engraved. Philatelic bureaux may take the assistance of treadle machine or other mechanical device approved by the Department to provide neat and distinct impressions.

56.3 Sometimes when a new flight is introduced by an Air Lines, National or International, a request is received to carry addressed covers on the inaugural flight from one point in the country to another or from one point in the country to another point in a foreign country. Generally, to identify such covers having been carried on the first flight, a special cancellation is provided at the point of origin. When such proposals are received and approved, the proponent will be requested to offer all such covers to the philatelic bureau on the eve of the flight for providing special cancellation. After doing so, the covers will be closed in a blue air mail bag and handed over to the air line concerned under receipt. Delivery post marks of the place of destination can also be provided if requested. This can be provided in a foreign country if the request is received sufficiently in advance by making arrangements with the Postal Administration of the country concerned.

57. Design of Cancellation

The designs of first day cancellation and special cancellation are selected by the Department. Such cancellations can be either pictorial or non-pictorial but should invariably contain the subject of the theme on the occasion of which these cancellations have been provided. The special place cancellations will have the same theme as of the first day cancellations, which are provided in the philatelic bureaux but with the name of the particular post office, other than a philatelic bureau, which is located in the particular place.

57.1 In the case of philatelic exhibition cancellations, the design may be either pictorial or non-pictorial preferably with a slogan conveying the message for promotion of philately. It should also indicate the name of the philatelic exhibition and the date(s) on which the exhibition is held in addition to the name of the post office at which the cancellation is provided. Such cancellations are provided at the venue of the exhibition by opening a special extension counter of the post office in the town where the exhibition is held. Normally for each day of the exhibition, different cancellation is provided like inaugural day, post office day, philatelists' day, award day etc. In case a pictorial design is adopted

for a philatelic cancellation, it should be ensured that the pictorial design adopted is a simple line drawing so that clear impressions can be obtained when the cancellation is provided.

57.2 In case of pictorial cancellations for places of major historical and tourist attraction, the design adopted must have relevance to the historical and tourist significance of the particular places. It should be in simple line drawing so that clear impressions can be obtained. It should be bilingual in Hindi and English. Regional language should not find place in the cancellations. Hindi will appear at the top and English below. Numerals, such as date, year etc., will be in Arabic numerals only.

58. Manufacture of Cancellation Cachet

The cachets for the first day cancellations and special place cancellations are supplied by the Head of the Circle to the philatelic bureaux and post offices concerned. The Postal Directorate circulates the common design of the cancellation for the commemorative stamp(s) inscribing the date of release, to all Heads of the Circles for getting the cachets manufactured at their end and supplied to all the philatelic bureaux under their jurisdiction. The cancellation cachet for philatelic exhibitions are also supplied by the Heads of the Circles concerned. After the design of a cancellation is approved, the Head of the Circle should arrange for local manufacturing of the cancellation cachet for philatelic exhibitions, as they are with fixed dates. For pictorial cancellations at places of historical importance or tourist attraction, the Head of Circle should take up with the Supdt. Postal Forms and Seals, Aligarh by supplying him with the necessary design much in advance of the date of introduction of the cancellation under intimation to all concerned. Since this cancellation will replace the date stamp cancellation, this should have provision for insertion of types for dates, months and years.

59. Guidelines for Providing Special Cancellation

The Heads of Postal Circles may approve and arrange for provision of special cancellation in all cases except those concerning diplomatic relations of India with other countries which will continue to be approved by the Postal Directorate, on realization of prescribed fees as given in this chapter subject to the terms and conditions mentioned earlier.

All proposals received in Circles for provision of philatelic exhibition cancellations and pictorial cancellations should be carefully scrutinized and personally approved by the Head of the Circle. The proposals should ordinarily be entertained if they are received at least **8 weeks** in advance. It should be ensured that the design is appropriate to the theme and the spellings are correct. It should be bilingual, in Hindi as well as in English. A copy of the letter issued by the Head of the Circle, approving the proposal of the cancellation along with a copy of the design, should invariably be sent to the Philately Branch of the Directorate for information and giving publicity in the newsletter brought out by the Department. In addition the Head of the Circle should also ensure country wide publicity as far as possible, at least **15 days** in advance of the due date of the provision of cancellation for the benefit of philatelists and others. They can also send a copy of the publicity material or a press note to the officer-in-charge of the Press Information Bureau for publicity in local news papers.

60. Charges for Special Cancellation

Once the proposal is approved, the proponent will be required to pay the Department the following fees:

- (i) Special cancellation/cover to be provided on working days — **Rs. 1500/-** per day per post office, **Rs. 3000/-** if it is to be provided at the premises of the proponent.
- (ii) Special cancellation/cover to be provided on Sundays and postal holidays — **Rs. 3000/-** per day per post office and **Rs. 6000/-** per day if it is to be provided at the premises of the proponent. The cancellation/cover will be provided during the normal working hours of the post offices. However, the Head of the Circle may offer **50%** concession on the rates for a special cancellation during District, State as well as Circle and National level philatelic exhibition if it is not organized by the Department.

61. Guidelines for Formal Release Function of Special Cover and Cancellation

61.1 The Department of Posts does not normally organize any formal function for release of Special Covers. The proponent or individual organizations who moot such proposals may, however, request the concerned Head of the Circle for permission to organize a function. This should be done sufficiently in advance and such a proposal should be accompanied by a draft minute-to-minute programme and dais plan of the proposed

function and a draft invitation card so that appropriate protocol is maintained and there is a uniformity of approach.

61.2 Any formal release function for a Special Cover by a dignitary of the central or state government should have an appropriate representative (usually Head of the Circle/Regional PMG of the concerned Circle/Region) of the Department of Posts. Exceptions to this are made only when the President of India, the Vice-President of India, the Prime Minister of India or the Speaker, Lok Sabha or Governor/Lt. Governor of a State/Union Territory consents for release of special covers. On such occasions the Minister of Communications/Minister of State for Communications normally presents the first Album containing the Cover to them for release. It is, therefore, imperative that the MOC/MOS(C) delivers his speech and introduces the special cover before its release. Regardless of the dignitary who is invited by the proponent to grace the occasion, it is necessary that letters of invitation issue from the proponent to the MOC/MOS(C) and Secretary, Department of Posts, (or the CPMG/PMG in Circle/Region level function) to ascertain their convenience.

61.3 The level of the Department's representation at a release function is generally decided keeping in view the level and status of the VIP who is to receive the first Album of the cover to mark its formal release.

61.4 It is the responsibility of the organizer to ensure that all the necessary arrangements for the functions including printing and issue of invitation cards, site preparation, security arrangements, liaison with press, T.V. etc. for publicity of the event etc. have been made.

61.5 If necessary, the proponent will have to arrange distribution of special covers to the VIPs attending the release function as well as material used in the presentation Albums at their own cost.

61.6 No formal release function for a special cover may be held without specific prior approval from the Department of Posts. The Department does not take any responsibility for extending the usual support as indicated above, for the release function, unless approval for the function has been obtained in advance.

Chapter VII: Deposit Account System

62. Deposit Account System for Collectors and Philatelists

A domestic philatelic deposit account system was introduced with effect from **1.8.1965** at all philatelic bureaux in India. The customers who wish to take advantage of this facility are supplied with the commemorative/special issues of stamps, F.D.Cs, information sheets and new postal stationery soon after their issue. The new postal stationery with advertisement issued by the Department of Posts can be supplied through philatelic deposit account opened at the selected philatelic bureaux only, namely, Bangalore, Chennai, Hyderabad, Kolkata, Lucknow, Mumbai and Sansad Marg, New Delhi. Domestic philatelic account holder can also obtain philatelic items issued by other philatelic bureaux and post offices by placing their demands with the Bureau where their accounts stand. The bureau will consolidate all such demands and place an indent on the bureau or the post office issuing philatelic items. The Philatelic Bureau/Post Office will treat the despatches as remittances to other Head Post Offices.

Philatelic Counters are functioning at all the Head Post Offices. The philatelic counter at offices other than philatelic bureaux would offer registration facility for opening of P.D. Account with supply of the material to be made by the parent bureau of the respective counter, with customers having the option to book from the counter of registration.

62.1 It is likely that opening and operating of Philatelic Deposit Accounts online will be enabled through the Virtual Post Office. In that case, the operational instructions for that will be suitably notified.

63. Conditions of Service

The account may be opened with a minimum deposit of **Rs. 200/-** in cash or by remittance by M.O. or by cheque/draft encashable in India. With the remittances the customers should also indicate clearly the types and quantities of philatelic items they desire to purchase with each issue of new stamp. They should also notify to the philatelic bureau in time, the changes of their addresses if any. The items indicated in the application form, will be dispatched to the customer automatically without any further order on the part of the customer. Such despatches will be made once a month in the first week of the month and will include all issues of the previous month. No dispatch will be made if

there has been no issue. If, however, a philatelic account holder desires dispatch of philatelic articles immediately after every release, full postage and registration fee will be debited against his account.

64. Mode of Dispatch and Charges for Dispatch of Philatelic Items

The items will be dispatched free "On Postal Service" by registered post unless the customer specifically desires that the items should be sent to him by insured post. In that event the insurance fee will be debited to his deposit account. No separate registration or insurance or postage charges will be levied unless otherwise desired by the customer in the circumstances stated above.

64.1 The Philatelic Deposit Account holder may also collect these items after every issue, by calling at the counter of the philatelic bureau. This, however, will not be allowed on the date of the issue of the stamp but on subsequent dates.

64.2 With each dispatch, a statement of account will be sent to the depositor indicating the value of the supplies made and the balance at credit remaining in the account of the customer. It will be the responsibility of the customer to replenish the deposit when the balance at credit becomes too low to cover the value of a single order. The deposit should be replenished by a sum of not less than **Rs. 200/-**. The account will become inoperative when the balance of the deposit is less than the value of a single order. The account will be brought into operation again only when a fresh deposit of **Rs. 200/-** is made. Where an account has become inoperative and a fresh deposit is not made within a period of **three months**, the balance at credit less commission will be remitted to the depositor by money order and the account finally closed. An account can also be closed on request from the depositor.

65. How to Open a Philatelic Deposit Account

If any one wishes to operate a Philatelic Deposit Account with the philatelic bureau, an application in the prescribed proforma as given in Annex IV (form for PDA application) may be sent to the Philatelic Bureau. A list of Philatelic Bureaux is given in Annex V (List of Bureaux).

66. Procedure at the Philatelic Bureau

A Philatelic Bureau will maintain an order register and also a ledger as given in Annex VI – (A) VI (B) register format for PDA and ledger respectively. The Philatelic Bureau will also prepare a statement of supplies made to philatelic deposit account holders every month.

66.1 On receipt of the application, at the Philatelic Bureau, the particulars of the names and addresses of the applicant will be noted in the Order Register chronologically. The required particulars in the application will be filled in and signed by the officer-in-charge. The application with the deposit amount should be sent to the Treasurer for crediting the amount under Unclassified Receipts.

66.2 After the particulars of credit have been intimated by the Treasurer, an account will be opened in the ledger. The particulars in the application should be noted very carefully in the ledger and the supervisor should initial these entries as well as the dispatch instructions at the top of the form. The applicant should then be intimated of the date on which his account has been opened and the number assigned to it. The application will then be placed in a guard file with the philatelic deposit account number noted thereon.

66.3 On each occasion when a dispatch has been made, the entries in the Ledger should be made and the balance struck and initialed by the Supervisor. A statement of account in the proforma as at Annex VII (statement of a/c) will be prepared and sent along with the dispatch. This should tally with the corresponding entry in the Ledger.

66.4 A monthly statement of the supplies made under the Deposit Account should be prepared. The amount shown in the monthly statement will be charged under 'Unclassified Payment'. This should be supported by a covering sanction for the consolidated amount charged under UCP, issued by the Divisional Superintendent/Postmaster (Group B and above) as the case may be. One copy of the statement along with a copy of the sanction memo covering the entire amount should be sent to the Postmaster for onward dispatch to the Director of Account (Postal) with the monthly cash account.

66.5 While dispatching the philatelic items, the material should be properly packed with cellophane envelopes and cardboard to give proper protection to them.

67. Concessions to Clubs and Societies

The Philatelic Clubs and Associations should be encouraged to open deposit accounts with Philatelic Bureaux and items of philately ordered by these clubs and associations should be dispatched free on Postal Service by registered post provided the minimum value of the order at a time is **Rs. 500/-** (Five Hundred only) or above. The individual members can collect their items from such clubs and associations.

68. Stamps of U.N. and Other Countries

Sometimes stamps of other countries and U.N. are made available for sale in India through Philatelic Bureaux. These stamps not being new issues brought out by the Department of Posts, India, will not come within the purview of Philatelic Deposit Account System. Such depositors should purchase them from the nominated Philatelic Bureau in the normal course. These stamps are to be sold only through selected Philatelic Bureaux namely Bangalore, Chennai, Kolkata, Mumbai and Sansad Marg, New Delhi and these are not to be supplied to Philatelic Counters for sale.

69. Deposit Account Service for Foreign Collectors

Philatelic Deposit Account Service is available to foreign collectors at Philatelic Bureau, Mumbai. As such, no other bureau in India should entertain applications from the foreign collectors. However, if any such application is received, this may be forwarded to the Director, Philatelic Bureau, Mumbai G.P.O. — 400001 for necessary action under intimation to the applicant.

70. Items Supplied

Collectors may place standing orders printed overleaf of the application form, for the supply of new commemorative or special issues of Indian stamps, First Day Covers, new stationery and brochures which would automatically be supplied by the Philatelic Bureau, Mumbai as soon as a new issue is brought out. They can also place order for 'Collectors Packs' issued annually by the Department of Posts.

71. Opening and Operation of Account

An account may be opened with a minimum deposit of an amount in foreign currency equivalent to **Rs. 5000/-** by cheque or bank draft encashable in India. In case the actual amount of cheque or bank draft realized in rupee currency is less than the prescribed amount of **Rs. 5000/-** on account of fluctuation in the rate of exchange, the depositor account would be debited with the amount of the difference between **Rs. 5000/-** and the amount actually realized.

Along with remittances, the customer should indicate clearly the types and quantities of Philatelic items they desire to purchase with each issue of new stamps. The minimum order on each occasion should not be less than an amount equivalent to **Rs. 500/-**.

72. Mode of Dispatch

The items will be dispatched under registered post unless the customer specifically desires otherwise. The actual postage prepaid will be debited against the deposit account. The packing charge at the rate of **two percent** of the value of items dispatched on each occasion subject to minimum of **Rs. 10/-** will also be levied.

73. Statement of Account and its Replenishment

With each dispatch a statement of account will be enclosed indicating the value of the supplies made and balance at credit remaining in the account of the customers. It will be the customer's responsibility to replenish the deposit when it approaches exhaustion. The deposit should be replenished by a sum of not less than an amount equivalent to **Rs. 2500/-** (Rs. Two thousand five hundred only). The account will become inoperative when the balance of the deposit is less than the value of a single order plus postage and packing charges. The account will be brought into operation again only if a fresh deposit of minimum amount is made.

74. Form of Opening the Account

The collectors who wish to avail of the Philatelic Deposit Account service may please send the application as given at Annex VIII (application for PD A/c overseas) duly filled in to the Philatelic Bureau, Mumbai G.P.O. 400001 (India) with necessary remittance. The form is also available on website of the Department of Posts: <http://www.indiapost.gov.in>

Chapter VIII: Miscellaneous

75. Guidelines for Issue of Commemorative/Special Postage Stamps

- (i) The subject of the stamp must be a theme of relevance to the nation, its policies and issues of concern.
- (ii) Proposals should be taken up well in advance about **two years** before the proposed date of issue along with full details to enable proper examination and obtaining recommendations of the Philatelic Advisory Committee. The proposals should be submitted in the format at Annex IX (format for proposal). This is also available on the website of India Post.
- (iii) A stamp on a living personality may not be issued.
- (iv) The personalities on whom commemorative stamps may be issued should be of national or international importance. The occasion to be commemorated must be the birth centenary or **10th/25th/50th/100th** death anniversary. To ensure objective assessment of the proposal no stamp will be issued sooner than **ten years** after the individual's death; only exceptions made will be in the case of deceased Heads of State.
- (v) Not more than one stamp may be issued on the same personality/monument/building/institution or organization.
- (vi) A stamp on an institution, building, monument etc. may be issued on its centenary/**125th** anniversary/**150th** anniversary etc. The building, institution to be so honoured must be a Heritage Preservation site of national/international importance. A building of regional importance may be commemorated with issue of special cover with special cancellation.
- (vii) Events of very important national or international character only may be considered for issue of the stamp. Events of regional significance may be commemorated through issue of a special cover with special cancellation.

(viii) Stamps may not be issued to honour commercial, political or sectarian organizations.

(ix) Stamps may not be issued to honour institutions or individuals whose main achievements are confined to the field of religion.

(x) Stamps may not be issued to honour schools, colleges, libraries, hospitals, municipalities, cities or similar institution due to the limitations placed in the annual stamp issue programme and the vast number of such things. It would be difficult to single out one for commemoration. It is advisable, if essential, to issue a stamp on the apex institution, not on individual branches.

(xi) Out of the commemorative/special stamps issued every year, those on personalities should not normally exceed 25%. Further, at least 25% stamps every year should be on popular themes like flora and fauna, arts and culture etc. These stamps will be issued under the series "Heritage India" and "Nature India"

76. Fictitious Stamps

The manufacture and use of fictitious postage stamps for any purpose whatsoever is prohibited and is an offence punishable under Section 263-A of the Indian Penal Code. Reproduction of stamps is allowed for illustration purposes in Philatelic publications or an article relating wholly on postage stamps which may appear in any magazine, newspaper or publication of a general character. Such production should, however, be only in black. If stamps are to be reproduced in colour for publicity purposes, prior permission of the Secretary, Department of Posts must be obtained. The Department of Posts has a policy to levy charges for issuing postage stamps for publicity, advertising, book covers etc. The policy operative at the time should be ascertained. To avoid similarity with the postage stamps such reproduction must be without perforation on the edges. A cross bar will also be placed on one corner of the stamp, obliterating the denomination. It must be noted that reproduction of the stamp in colour of the actual size of the stamp with perforation on the edges may be deemed to be taken as production of the actual stamp. Postage stamps used for advertisement, on book covers, sleeves of CDs, DVDs etc. or on any hoarding, billboard or for any kind of publicity by any person or

organization other than the Department of Posts, are likely to be charged an amount to be determined by the Department at the time of approving its use.

77. Coloured Blow-ups of Stamps

From time to time the Postal Department brings out blow-ups of stamps on important personalities and events. Functions are also held on very selective basis for release of the stamps at places associated with the personalities or events concerned. For this purpose the blow-up of a commemorative stamp is supplied by the Department. After the function the blow-up is normally donated to the proponents as a token of good will in arranging the release function. On the rare occasions where the Department itself arranges a stamp release function, the blow-up should be neatly got framed and hung in the nearby post office.

Apart from the release functions, blow-ups are also prepared and supplied to the proponents and interested parties. These are not free and are supplied on receiving firm orders with advance payment at the rate decided by the Department from time to time. These blow-ups can also be supplied to Heads of Postal Circles for decorating the offices on payment.

78. Release Functions

A release function need not necessarily be held for each and every issue but selectively for certain issues depending upon the requirements of the occasion/proponent. The relevant instructions will be followed by Heads of Circles whenever a stamp release function is being organized either by the proponent or by the Department. The guidelines for the release functions are given below this rule. When a stamp release function is being organized by the proponent, the Head of the Circle will keep constant liaison with the proponent sufficiently in advance of the scheduled date of the function. When the Communications Minister is attending such a function, Head of the Circle should personally visit the venue to acquaint himself with the place so that on the date of release function, the Communications Minister is not put to any inconvenience or embarrassment. The organizers should be told to finalise the draft invitation card, dais plan and minute-to-minute programme of the function in advance and a copy of the same may be sent to the Directorate for information of the Communications Minister. When

the stamp release function forms a part of a bigger function on the occasion of which the stamp is being released, the stamp release would ordinarily find place in the programme in the beginning. Release is normally done by presenting an album containing the stamps and the first day cover and unveiling the blow-up. After presentation, the chief guest will exhibit the album in his hands to facilitate photography by the media. Where feasible, a blow-up of the stamp will be unveiled.

Heads of the Circles will intimate the Directorate well in advance of their requirement of presentation albums, FDCs, souvenir folders etc. so that the Directorate can send these in time to them. A blow-up of the same will also generally be prepared by the Directorate for sending it to the Head of the Circle in whose jurisdiction such a release function is being organized. Heads of Circles may send a suitable representative to Philately Division to collect all material for the release. The blow-up will be donated to the proponents at the end of the function.

When a function is arranged by the Department itself the blow-up will be sent to the philatelic bureau or the nearest post office as the case may be. It will be the responsibility of the Head of the Circle to ensure that the release functions are held befitting the image of the Department.

78.1 Guidelines for Holding of Formal Stamp Release Function

(i) The Department of Posts does not normally organize any formal function for release of commemorative/Special postage stamps. The proponent of particular stamp(s) or individual organizations who moot such proposals and provide background material for design and information brochure etc. can, however, request the Department for permission to organize a function. This should, however, be done sufficiently in advance and such a proposal should be accompanied by a draft minute-to-minute programme and dais plan of the proposed function and a draft invitation card so that the Department could adopt uniformity of approach.

(ii) Any formal release function for a stamp should have an appropriate representative of the Department of Posts. The postage stamp, which is the legally valid receipt for postage paid, can be released by either the Minister for Communications or Minister of State for Communications. In case it is not convenient for either of them to release the stamp, the

postage stamp can be released by the Secretary, Department of Posts, Member of the Postal Services Board or the Chief Postmaster General concerned. Exceptions to this are made only when the President of India, the Vice-President of India, the Prime Minister of India, the Speaker, Lok Sabha or the Governor/Lt. Governor of the State/Union Territory consent to release the postage stamp. On such occasions the MOC/MOS(C) requests the President/Vice-President/Prime Minister or the Speaker, Lok Sabha to unveil the blow-up of the commemorative stamp and thereafter he presents the first Album to them for release. It is, therefore, imperative that the MOC/MOS(C) delivers his speech and introduces the stamp before actually requesting them for its release. Regardless of the dignitary who is invited by the proponent to grace the occasion, it is necessary that letters of invitation issue from the proponent to the MOC/MOS(C) and Secretary, Department of Posts, to ascertain their convenience. The proponent may be advised to obtain the confirmation/consent of dignitaries well in advance and inform the Department for further action. Requests for change of date are not generally entertained as they reflect poorly upon the philatelic practices of the country concerned.

(iii) Proposal for the formal release function must be mooted sufficiently in advance of the scheduled date of release of the stamp along with draft minute to minute programme of the proposed function, draft invitation cards and dais plan. This is necessary to enable the Department to ensure the desired uniformity/standard and protocol which is required to be maintained in view of the Department's official involvement in such functions.

(iv) The level of the Department's representation at a release function is decided keeping in view the level and status of the dignitary who is to receive the first Album of the stamp to mark its formal release.

(v) In addition to the Presentation Album, the Department of Posts also contributes towards such formal release function(s) by providing (a) a blow-up of the stamp for display at the venue of the release function (b) deluxe albums for presentation to the principal dignitaries at the function, and (c) **one hundred** first day covers along with information brochures for distribution among the distinguished invitees present on the occasion.

(vi) Additional albums of stamps, first day covers, etc. can be obtained by the organizers of formal release function on payment, for which the exact requirement must be communicated to the Department or to the concerned Chief Postmaster General well in advance of the scheduled date of release. Throughout the process of organizing the function, the concerned Chief Postmaster General may be kept informed and consulted.

(vii) It is also customary for the Department to provide a special stamp sale counter at the venue of the function, on demand.

(viii) It is the responsibility of the organizers to ensure that all the necessary arrangements for the function including printing and issue of invitation cards, site preparation, security arrangements, liaison with Press, T.V. etc. for publicity of the events etc. have been made.

(ix) Since the stamp is simultaneously released in about **1200** outlets across the country, no request for a change in the date of release would normally be entertained once it has been fixed. The brochures and cancellations carry the date of issue and reprinting/remanufacture and fresh distribution of these items is an avoidable waste.

(x) The organizer of the release function should compulsorily invite the local Members of Parliament/State Legislature to the function and to ensure that their names find mention in the invitation card and proper seating arrangement are made for MPs in accordance with the Warrant of Precedence. The organizer will also ensure that the local members of the Philatelic Advisory Committee are invariably invited to the function.

(xi) No formal release function for a stamp can be held without specific prior approval from the Department of Posts. The Department does not take any responsibility for extending the usual support as indicated above, for the release function, unless approval for the function has been obtained in advance.

(xii) In case of any dispute, difference of opinion etc. among proponents, there will be no release function. Stamp sale will begin across the counter on the scheduled date of issue.

78.2 Instructions to Departmental Officers/Officials for Coordinating/Organizing Formal Stamp Release Functions

Note: These instructions are only for departmental functionaries. They supplement the existing guidelines for formal stamp release functions which are to be given to the

proponents. All Heads of Circles and Regional PMsG may refer to Directorate letter No. **16-143/95-Phil dated 30/10/2002** and **7/11/2002** or obtain a copy thereof from Philately Division.

79. Philatelic Assistance in Ceremonial Functions

Postage stamps are sometimes used very liberally in local functions by individuals and organizations. Often, it takes the form of presentation of album containing stamps to various dignitaries on the dais, in order to add ceremonial value and authenticity to such functions. Postage stamps are first and last valid legal receipt for postage paid for availing any service provided by the Department of Posts. Collection of postage stamps has philatelic importance and in that respect also, the matter is of exclusive relevance for the Department of Posts.

Such liberal and unauthorized use of postage stamps by anyone or any organization without obtaining prior approval of the Department should be guarded against. However, there would be no objection if the organizers on their own come up with an album of stamps purchased from the Department of Posts.

80. Periodical Report

A Monthly Report on Philately Promotion and Development has been prescribed for submission to the Postal Directorate (Philately Section). In order to assess the revenue of the Department from the sale of philatelic material such as commemorative/special stamps and definitive stamps (whenever new stamps are issued), first day covers, new postal stationery (whenever introduced), postal stationery with advertisement, commemorative postal stationery etc. the Circle Office will compile the data on each segment of the report from all the philatelic bureaux and counters and forward a consolidated statement to Postal Directorate, New Delhi on the **5th of each month**, in the prescribed format at Annex X (format of statement from Bureaux to date).

(a) Philatelic Bureaux and philatelic counters will maintain a register in which they will note down sales of undermentioned items:

(i) Postal stationery with advertisement (for designated philatelic bureaux at Bangalore, Chennai, Hyderabad, Kolkata, Lucknow, Mumbai and Sansad Marg, New Delhi only).

(ii) New Postal stationery/postal stationery with new designs.

(iii) Commemorative stamps of each issue separately.

(iv) FDCs and Brochures of each issue.

(v) Collectors' Packs

(vi) Albums

(vii) Greeting Cards

(viii) Stamp Packets

(ix) Thematic Packs

(x) Blow-ups

(xi) Miniature Sheets

(xii) Souvenir Sheets

(xiii) Philatelic items during exhibitions

(b) In addition to the above, the statistics in respect of the following should also be noted in the register separately:

(i) Fee collected for special cover/cancellation.

(ii) Value of the stamp, FDC, brochures etc. supplies to other Philatelic counters.

(iii) Amount charged under UCP for making supply of philatelic items under Philatelic Deposit Scheme and also delivery of philatelic products against payment deposited in advance.

(iv) Amount of postal stationery and stamps cancelled with special/slogan/exhibition cancellations.

(c) Post Offices other than the philatelic bureaux authorized by the Heads of the Circles for sale of stamps, first day covers and publicity folders will also maintain a register in

which the sales in respect of each stamp effected at such post offices are noted. The monthly total of such register indicating separately the sales in respect of each item will be intimated to the Circle office by **2nd of the following month** directly the concerned office.

(d) Authorised offices which receive supply of commemorative/special postage stamps directly from the Stamp Depot will also maintain the registers prescribed for the philatelic bureau, in respect of stamps only and will send the monthly sales statement directly to the Circle Office on **2nd of each month**. The format of the statement is given in Annex XI.

80.2 Philatelic counters are functioning in each Head Post Office other than the philatelic bureaux. These counters provide registration facility to open P.D. Accounts with supply by the parent bureau. A statement in respect of philatelic deposit account opened will be sent to the parent philatelic bureau every quarter. The parent philatelic bureau will compile the figures of PD Accounts standing at the attached philatelic counters and will send the consolidated statement in the prescribed format given in Annexure XI to the Circle Office.

81. New Postal Stationery with advertisement issued by the Department of Posts will be sold through Bangalore, Chennai, Hyderabad, Kolkata, Lucknow, Mumbai and Sansad Marg, New Delhi, philatelic bureaux only on the day of release. These items can also be supplied through Philatelic Deposit Account opened at these designated philatelic bureaux. Domestic philatelic account holders can obtain these items by placing their demands with the bureau where their respective deposit accounts stand.

82. Distance Learning Package

The Department has been providing 'Distance Learning Philately' at its Postal Training Centres and Postal Staff College of India, Ghaziabad. The course is intended to equip the Philately service personnel with necessary knowledge of this hobby, knowledge of the products/service and with marketing skills. The activities in the Distance Learning Course broadly comprise of Study material, Questionnaire and Project Work. The Course formulated by the Postal Training Centre, Mysore is quite popular.

83. Compact Disk on Philately

The Department has been providing Compact Disks (CDs) on Philately. These CDs give an overview of Indian Philately – necessary knowledge of its hobby, knowledge of the products/service like theme-wise list of stamps, their scanned images etc. Kolkata GPO and Andhra Pradesh Circle, Hyderabad prepared the CDs and the same are available as a saleable item in all the Philatelic Bureaux of the country.

84. Bibliography

The followings are some standard reference books on philately, which can be retained by philatelic bureaux/counters:

S. No.	Name of the Book	Author
1.	Stamp Collection for Beginners	Rakesh Walia
2.	Stamp Collecting	Manoharlal Chowdhary
3.	A Guide to Stamp Collection Part I	M.S. Bhaskaran Nair
4.	Phil India	Manik Jain
5.	Specialised Catalogue of Modern Indian Stamps	Dr. S.P. Gupta
6.	How to Arrange and Write up a Stamp Collection	Stanley Phillips & C.P. Rang
7.	A Survey of Birds through Philately	A.V. Radha Krishnan
8.	Sports	Dinesh Chandra Sharma – published by Institute of Philately
9.	Mahatma Gandhi (A Numismatic and Philatelic Study)	Dr. S.K. Bhatt
10.	The Stamp of Truth (Mahatma Gandhi's Quotations)	Suresh Dalal
11.	Priced Guide to Philatelic Literature	—
12.	An Introduction to India used abroad	V.S. Dastur

13.	The Philatelic Societies Year Book (1953-54)	The British Phil Association
14.	Philatelic articles published in vernacular press (1994-1997)	Dinesh Mistry
15.	India's Freedom Struggle through India Postage Stamp	Mr. V.S. Saxena
16.	Who's Who on Indian Stamps	Sushma Suresh
17.	A Drive to Promote Philately through Govt. Publication & Press	Dinesh Mistry

Chapter IX: The Laws of the Land

85. Sales Tax

The Sales Tax in India is charged at two levels: Local for sales within a state and Central for inter-state sales. The Central Sales Tax is charged in addition to the Local Sales Tax.

Sales Tax laws do not mention philatelic items specifically. However, these laws are applicable to all sales except those that are specifically exempted by a notice.

86. Import & Export

(a) Commodity Classification for Imports

The new **8-digit** commodity classification for imports was adopted from **April 1, 2002**.

Code	Description
4907 00 10	Indian unused postage, revenue or similar stamps including stamp-impressed paper of current or new issue
9704 00 10	Postage or revenue stamps, used or unused
9704 00 20	Stamp-post marks, first-day covers, used or unused
9704 00 90	Postal stationery (stamped paper), and the like, used or unused
9704 00 90	Philatelic accessories

(b) Import

Import is free for stamps other than those covered under heading '4907 00 10'.

The import of items covered under '4907 00 10' is restricted. Specific permit or license from the Director General of Foreign Trade is required for import of items under this heading.

(c) Custom Tariff

There is also no Custom Duty on stamps other than those covered under heading '4907 00 10' where it is charged at the rate of **25%** of the face value.

(d) Export

There are no restrictions to export of stamps that are less than **100 years** old.

(e) The Antiquities & Art Treasures Act, 1972 (52 of 1972)

The definition of Antiquity under this Act includes any coin, sculpture, painting, epigraph or other work of art or craftsmanship; any article, object or thing detached from a building or cave; any article, object or thing illustrative of science, art, crafts, literature, religion, customs, morals or politics in bygone ages; any article, object or thing of historical interest; which has been in existence for not less than **one hundred years**. And any manuscript, record or other document which is of scientific, historical, literary or aesthetic value and which has been in existence for not less than **seventy five years**.

The registration of antiquities specified below is compulsory:

Sculptures in stone, terracotta, metals, ivory, and bone, paintings (including miniatures and tanks) in all media (paper, wood, cloth, silk, and the like), and manuscripts containing paintings, illustrations or illuminations (adornment with colored lettering).

The Director General of the Archaeological Survey of India is the authority competent to issue permit under Section 3 of the Antiquities & Art Treasures Act for the export of any antiquity and art treasure.